

Tempus — Fork Release Notes

Baseline: the January 2026 distribution (`BUILD_META.buildDate: '2026-01-02'`). **This build:** July 2026, after roughly two months of sustained iteration.

This document is for the original author. Your copy of the app has been heavily extended and re-designed; this is a map of what changed, why, and — most importantly — what it means for the spreadsheet schema and for any code of yours that might meet data written by this fork. It is not a paint job: the diff is ~15,000 net new lines (39,346 → 54,205 across backend + views), a new time-entry model, three new pages, and four new sheet columns — with your financial engine deliberately left untouched.

What was deliberately NOT touched

Your core money engine is byte-for-byte identical to the January baseline:

- `invoices.js` (1,822 lines), `bas.js`, `tax.js`, `deductions.js`, `deductionCategories.js`, `deductionExceptions.js`, `actualincome.js`
- `entry-core.html` (the shared punch/duration helpers)
- `ratepreview.js` differs by exactly one line: its entry read now filters out the new `entry_type='break'` records so breaks never count as billable time (see Data & compatibility)
- The release/version plumbing (`releaseInfo.js`, `version.js`) — though see [Update mechanism](#) below.

Everything below was built *around* that engine, on the principle that reporting, invoicing and tax maths must never change under a UX iteration.

The headline: time entry is a different model now

The January app recorded time as one Basic (total hours) or one Punch entry per day per hour type, chosen by a tab. This fork reframes the day as **a canvas of sessions**:

- **Per-contract entry modes.** Each contract is either *Simple* (log total hours) or *Detailed* (log sessions with start/end times), with a global default (Settings → Default entry mode). Every surface — desktop day modal, pickers, quick actions, mobile — derives what it offers from the modes of the contracts valid on that day, plus any entries already logged. A Simple-only user never sees the word "Sessions"; a Detailed-only day never shows a Total-hours field.
- **The Punch tab became a Sessions timeline editor.** The day modal composes every session across all hour types and contracts into one colour-coded timeline. Times are edited in place with batch semantics (edit several rows, one Save; whole-batch validation, nothing commits if any row is invalid). Smart time parsing ("9 → 5") with am/pm anchoring from the previous session's boundary.
- **Explicit break records.** Gaps between sessions materialise as real break records — `entry_type='break'`, one record per (date, contract), spans stored in `punches_json` — kept in

sync by a bounded reconcile engine that trims and coalesces spans as sessions move. Breaks are structurally excluded from worked totals, income, and exports.

- **Per-day notes.** `entry_type='comment'` records (one per day) carry a free-text note, editable from the Sessions tab, marked on the calendar.
- **Named day templates per contract.** A Detailed contract can store multiple named templates ("Office day", "Half day at home") — each a set of sessions with hour types and an optional comment. One click lays down the whole day, dedup-safe, via the bulk API.
- **Quality-of-life rules** carried into every path: overnight punch-out splits across two days; positive durations floor to one rounding interval; sub-2-minute accidental sessions are discarded; punch-out double-taps are ignored; a live clock shows in the header while punched in.
- **Recurring + Bulk schedules understand sessions** (a `sessions_json` column was added to both schedule sheets): time input follows the selected contract's mode, instances carry their spans as punches, and reconciliation is punches-aware.

Calendar, Agenda, and the day modal

- **New Agenda view** (didn't exist in January): a mini-month beside a weekly list with a progress bar and today marker. Calendar/Agenda is the landing surface, toggle persisted.
- **Calendar redesigned** full-width; cell colour encodes deviation from target hours rather than decoration; day modal replaces the right-hand rail.
- **Right-click quick menu on any day** (new system): per-hour-type quick actions, copy yesterday / copy last week, apply a day template, per-entry edit/delete rows, clear day, and a one-click Punch out when exactly one punch is open.
- **Quick actions** are configured on the hour type (`quick_fill_enabled`, `quick_fill_hours`, `quick_fill_mode`, `icon` — four new hour-type columns): one click either fills a fixed number of hours or starts the punch clock. Actions are entry-mode-aware (a fill action only targets Simple contracts, offering one item per candidate contract when ambiguous) and actions that cannot apply on a given day are hidden rather than greyed.

Mobile is effectively a new app

The January mobile view was a single form. It is now an app-like experience sharing the same data:

- Phone auto-detection with a redirect + tappable fallback splash (`mobile-detect.html`, new), view preference remembered; proper viewport via `HtmlOutput.addMetaTag` (inline meta viewport is ignored by Apps Script — this one line is why the old mobile view rendered tiny).
- One-tap punch clock (saves immediately, live timer, double-tap guard), tap-to-edit session editor, in-app numeric keypad (no native keyboard, so no GAS viewport jump), iOS-style swipe-to-delete.
- The same day-mode chrome as desktop: sole-mode days hide the Basic/Punch toggle entirely; contract pickers are filtered per surface.
- A quick sheet mirroring desktop quick actions, including day templates.

- localStorage caching with background revalidation and a tab-return resync (contracts and hour types edited on desktop arrive on the phone without a reload), optimistic saves with server-truth reconciliation, idempotent deletes.
- Device-local theme override (the phone can run a different theme than the synced setting).

Theming became a system

January had a settings dropdown with built-in themes and a single custom slot. Now:

- **Multiple named custom themes** (`custom_themes` JSON in settings) with favourites, stored alongside a theme-ref scheme (`theme: 'dark'` or `'custom:<id>'`). The legacy single custom slot is auto-migrated.
- **A Themes page** (new partial) — gallery grouped Favourites / Built-in / Accessibility / Custom, where every card renders a **live miniature of the app in that theme** (nav sliver + agenda rows driven by the theme's own CSS variables) instead of colour swatches.
- **A theme editor** with live preview: an app-mock canvas repaints on every colour input beside a components panel proving text legibility, backed by WCAG contrast validation that blocks saving on hard failures.
- **An overrides layer**: duplicating a theme captures every hand-tuned token that deviates from the 8-colour generator's derivation, so bespoke details (e.g. Velvet Espresso's warm agenda tints) survive duplication while everything else keeps re-deriving live.
- New/overhauled built-ins (including Velvet Espresso and a reworked Light), colour-blind themes surfaced in the gallery, first-paint theming server-side so custom themes don't flash, and an optional logo-accent toggle.

Contracts and other pages

- **Contracts**: four new columns — `color` (identity colour used across calendar/agenda/charts), `archived` (hidden from pickers, preserved for history), `entry_mode`, `standard_day_json` (day templates). New APIs: `api_setContractArchived`, `api_deleteContractWithEntries`. Dashboard redesigned (section spine, chart cards, on-page terminology, collapsible logged hours). Contract rows are written by header name, not position, so schema drift can't corrupt a row.
- **Annual Views** redesigned: KPI tiles with count-up and year-over-year chips, hero chart, allocation bar + packed bubbles (replacing donuts), your existing insights reworked into a feed, income trend with actual-vs-forecast split bars.
- **Rate Preview** redesigned around the delta ("you keep X%"), to-date vs full-contract toggle.
- **Settings** rebuilt as a searchable, area-based workbench; gated settings nest under their feature flag.
- **Public Holidays page** (new partial + `api_getPublicHolidaysForYear`): themed list with state pills and year navigation.
- **Print monthly** redesigned to mirror the app's tiled days while deliberately staying white / ink-light.
- **Xero**: a generated console script autofills a whole month of the Xero timesheet UI from Tempus data (pivot-store injection, never saves), plus research groundwork for per-session start/end export.

Under the hood

- **Optimistic UI with reconciliation** everywhere: entries appear/update instantly, pending-add markers survive background syncs, temp records are swapped for server-confirmed rows, and a silent auto-resync runs when the tab regains focus (the manual "Refresh from server" was retired).
 - **Duplicate safety**: entries are keyed (date, hour type, contract) with sentinel keys for break/comment records; the bulk API dedups server-side; `api_addEntry` now returns the *existing* row on duplicate so clients adopt real records (this also fixed a latent bug in the January code path where the attempted payload's fresh id was returned instead).
 - **Design system**: shared custom select, flatpickr-based date pickers with range linking, a radius scale, one input-focus-ring contract, hover states derived from each surface's own background, toast conventions, form validation that flags every empty mandatory field at once. The stylesheet grew 979 → 3,177 lines.
 - **Routing/boot** (`webapp.js` 219 → 427): view switching, mobile detection support, first-paint theme CSS injection.
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Data & compatibility — read this section first

The fork migrates its own spreadsheet automatically (header-reset migrations run on write), but if **your January code ever reads a sheet written by this fork**, be aware:

1. **timesheet_entries** now contains non-work row kinds. `entry_type` can be `'break'` or `'comment'` in addition to `'basic'` / `'advanced'`. Break/comment rows have a blank `hour_type_id` and carry spans/notes. January code that sums `duration_minutes` without filtering `entry_type` will double-count breaks as worked time and render phantom rows.
2. **contracts** grew from 10 to 14 columns: `color`, `archived`, `entry_mode`, `standard_day_json` (inserted before `created_at`). Positional reads of `created_at` at index 9 will break; reads by header name are safe.
3. **hour_types** grew from 11 to 15 columns: `quick_fill_enabled`, `quick_fill_hours`, `icon`, `quick_fill_mode`.
4. **Recurring/bulk schedule sheets** gained `sessions_json`.
5. **New settings keys** (key/value sheet, additive, safe to ignore): `default_entry_mode`, `target_hours_per_day`, `custom_themes`, `favourites`, `custom_themes_migrated`, `hour_types_quick_fill_migrated`, and several UI preferences.
6. Two feature flags were retired (`custom_theme`, `enable_colorblind_themes`) — both features are now always on.

Update mechanism — deliberately suppressed, not removed. Early in the fork's life the "instance out of date" banner was permanently nagging (correctly, from its point of view: the fork stopped taking distribution updates, and its `BUILD_META.buildDate` is still frozen at `2026-01-02` because your `write-version.sh` pipeline isn't part of this fork's deploy). It was silenced with the smallest possible change: `applyUpdateIndicators()` in `scripts.html` now unconditionally hides the nav banner and

the About "Update" badge, with a comment explaining why. Everything else is intact —

`api_checkForUpdate` still polls your GitHub repo, and the About page still reports the upstream status honestly.

Two things follow from this:

- **If you fold any of this fork's code back into your distributed line, do not carry that `applyUpdateIndicators` change across** — restore your original body (it's a self-contained function) or your users will silently stop seeing update notices.
- Within this fork, re-enabling the banner as-is would be noise (the frozen build date makes every upstream commit read as "out of date"). A meaningful re-enable would also need the build-date stamping restored to the fork's deploy process.

Beyond that, treat this codebase as a separate line; anything you'd like to fold back into the main line is yours to take.

Numbers

MEASURE	JAN 2026	JUL 2026
Total lines (backend + views)	39,346	54,190
Main client bundle (<code>scripts.html</code>)	24,395	34,217
Stylesheet (<code>head.html</code>)	979	3,175
Mobile bundle	1,427	2,587
Pages/partial	22	25 (+ Themes, Public Holidays, mobile-detect)
<code>contracts</code> columns	10	14
<code>hour_types</code> columns	11	15
Entry record kinds	2	4 (+ break, comment)
Files untouched	—	7 backend engine files byte-identical (+1 one-line fix)

Compact change list

Time entry & sessions — per-contract Simple/Detailed modes · sessions timeline day editor with batch edit · explicit break records with auto-reconcile + coalescing · per-day notes · named multi day-templates per contract · overnight punch split · rounding floor · sub-2-min session discard · smart time parse with am/pm anchoring · header live clock · punch-out from calendar menu · recurring/bulk with sessions.

Calendar & agenda — Agenda view (new) · calendar redesign (deviation colouring, day modal) · right-click day menu: quick actions, copy yesterday/last week, day templates, per-entry rows, clear day,

punch out · day comment dots.

Quick actions — per-hour-type config (fill hours or start punch, own icon/duration) · desktop menu + mobile sheet · entry-mode-aware contract resolution · per-contract disambiguation · inapplicable actions hidden.

Mobile — phone auto-detect + splash + view preference · viewport fix · app-shell redesign · one-tap clock, live timers · keypad entry · swipe-to-delete · session editor · quick sheet with day templates · day-mode chrome · cache + background revalidation + tab-return resync · device-local themes.

Theming — multi named custom themes + favourites · Themes page with live mini-preview cards · editor live canvas + contrast validation · overrides capture on duplicate · accessibility themes surfaced · new/overhauled built-ins · first-paint theming · logo accent toggle.

Pages — contracts dashboard redesign + colours/archive/delete-with-entries · Annual Views redesign (KPI count-up + YoY chips, hero chart, bubbles, insights, forecast bars) · Rate Preview redesign · Settings workbench · Public Holidays page · print monthly redesign · expense category charts.

Platform — optimistic UI + sync reconciliation + silent auto-resync · duplicate-safe composite keys & bulk dedup · `api_addEntry` duplicate returns existing row (bug fix) · idempotent deletes · design system (selects, pickers, rings, radii, toasts, validation) · routing/boot rework · status pill reserved for on-the-clock.